

News Weekly

NASA has postponed the Artemis II moon launch due to complications encountered during a rehearsal.

NASA announced on Tuesday a postponement of its mission to send four astronauts around the Moon, citing complications encountered during a critical rocket test. During a "wet dress rehearsal" at the Kennedy Space Center in Florida, engineers detected a hydrogen leak at the base of the Space Launch System rocket, which led to an early termination of the test with approximately five minutes remaining. Shortly after 2 a.m. ET, NASA confirmed that it would forgo the February launch window for Artemis II to analyze data and conduct an additional test, with March being considered the earliest potential launch opportunity (NBC News).



Video Shows Punxsutawney Phil Predicting Six More Weeks of Winter

On the heels of a brutal stretch of bitter cold and snow, Punxsutawney Phil has predicted another six weeks of winter after seeing his shadow early Monday morning. Despite the cold, thousands of people gathered at Gobbler's Knob in Punxsutawney, Pennsylvania, to celebrate Groundhog Day and watch Phil emerge from his stump and make his prediction for 2026. The seasonal celebration began around 3 a.m. before Tom Dunkel, president of the Groundhog Club's Inner Circle, knocked on Phil's burrow three times to coax him out. After Dunkel spoke "Groundhogese" with Phil, Vice President Dan McGinley read the scroll containing Phil's prediction: "It is my job this February 2 to look to the skies and report back to you, that there is a shadow here on my ground, six more weeks of winter abound!" (Source: CBS)



Common diabetes drug shows promise for treating macular degeneration

Age-related macular degeneration (AMD) is a leading cause of vision loss in adults over 50, affecting about 11 million people in the U.S., a number expected to double by 2050. AMD impairs central vision, making tasks like reading challenging. The two main types are dry AMD, which accounts for 80-90% of cases and involves gradual vision loss due to macular thinning, and wet AMD, which is less common but more severe, caused by leaking blood vessels that damage the macula. While dry AMD has no cure, lifestyle changes may slow its progression, and wet AMD can be treated with monthly eye injections if caught early. Researchers are exploring metformin, a diabetes drug, for its potential anti-aging effects and benefits against age-related diseases, which may extend to AMD. (Source: University of Chicago)



A Harry Potter villain is now an unlikely new-year mascot in China

With the Year of the Horse galloping into view, an unexpected face has emerged in China as a symbol of fortune: a villain from Harry Potter's wizarding world. Draco Malfoy, Potter's privileged teen nemesis in J.K. Rowling's wildly successful book series, is popping up in festive displays in the country ahead of the Lunar New Year.

The good fortune is in the name: "Malfoy" is transliterated as "Ma Er Fu" in Mandarin. The first word "Ma" means "horse" (马), while the third refers to good fortune (福). Read together, it sounds like horses are bringing good luck. Videos on Chinese social media show people adorning their homes with red posters carrying well-wishing phrases, known as fai chun or chunlian, in an annual festive ritual. (Source: CNN)

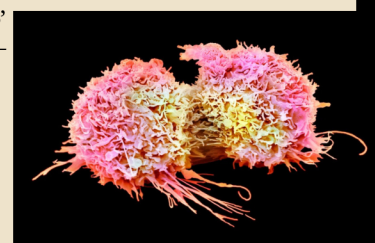


How tumours trick the brain into shutting down cancer-fighting cells

Tumours boost their own growth by attracting and then commandeering nearby sensory neurons, a study finds. By 'plugging into' tumour cells, these neurons can send a signal to the brain that subdues the protective activity of immune cells at the tumour site — allowing the cancerous cells to proliferate unchecked.

The study, published today in *Nature*, pinpointed this signalling pathway, from the tumour to the brain and back again, in mice with lung cancer. "The tumour hijacks the signalling axis and uses it for its own purpose," says Anna-Maria Globig, a cancer immunologist at the Allen Institute for Immunology in Seattle, Washington.

When the authors of the study used genetic engineering to inactivate, or 'knock out', the sensory neurons, they "saw such a huge, dramatic reduction" in tumour growth — more than 50% — says co-author Chengcheng Jin, a cancer immunologist at the University of Pennsylvania in Philadelphia. (Source: Nature)



Spelling Bee



	6		8		1		2	
3		8	6					
		4	3		7	5		
8				6		7		
		1	9			3		6
6	9		1	7	3			
		6	2					7
	8			1			4	5
		7	5	3	8	6		2

Slow Cooker Salisbury Steak

If you're craving a comforting and hearty dinner, look no further than this Slow Cooker Salisbury Steak. With its rich, savory flavors and tender texture, it's a dish that transforms simple ingredients into a delightful meal. Perfect for busy days, this recipe allows you to set it up in the morning and return to a ready-made dinner. Pair it with creamy mashed potatoes or steamed vegetables for a complete and satisfying meal that's sure to please the whole family.

- Packaged gravy mixes: The secret weapon of flavor! Mixing au jus and dry onion soup gives your dish that "been simmering all day" vibe without the wait.
 - Condensed cream of chicken soup: This magic potion turns your meal into a creamy dream, staying luscious even when cooked low and slow!
 - Bread crumbs and milk: The dynamic duo known as "panade" works wonders. It keeps your beef patties juicy and whole, making them the superheroes of moisture and flavor!
 - ****Make beef patties****: Combine beef, breadcrumbs, milk, and onion soup mix; form eight patties.
 - ****Dredge and sear****: Coat patties in flour and brown in a skillet over medium-high heat.
 - ****Prepare in slow cooker****: Stack patties alternately in the slow cooker for even flavor distribution.
 - ****Make sauce****: Mix water, condensed soup, and au jus mix, then pour over patties.
- **Cook****: Slow cook until beef is done and gravy is rich brown, then serve over mashed potatoes or noodles.

